Drought Management and Resilience

GS III

- Drought is not determined by low rainfall alone. Authorities also examine **soil moisture**, crop damage, water availability and local conditions to understand its severity. This helps distinguish temporary rainfall shortages from situations requiring government intervention.

- States assess drought conditions and request additional financial assistance when their resources are insufficient. The Centre examines these assessments before releasing **disaster relief funds**. Delays can worsen farmers' difficulties because crop losses reduce income while cultivation expenses and debts remain.

- Financial compensation provides immediate support but cannot prevent future drought losses. Farmers remain vulnerable when **groundwater** is extracted faster than it is replenished or when crops require more water than local rainfall and available irrigation can sustainably provide.

- Long-term protection requires **efficient irrigation**, suitable crop choices, groundwater conservation and wider agricultural insurance coverage. Government incentives can encourage these changes, helping farmers maintain production and income even when rainfall becomes unreliable due to changing climatic conditions.

Effective drought management combines reliable assessment, timely financial assistance and sustainable farming practices to protect livelihoods while reducing dependence on emergency relief.